

Loss Ville

It might not matter much to most of us, but India loses an exorbitant amount of money thanks to people playing Farmville. Read on to find out how and (very roughly) just how much

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Whilst working on the gaming issue, someone came up with the idea of calculating how much gaming costs us all in hard cash. Now this is obviously ridiculous, and cannot be calculated without going insane, but since a lot of people in our office seem to waste time with *FarmVille*, we decided to calculate how much that silly game costs India on a yearly basis. We chose not to calculate the same for our sessions of *Quake III*, because that actually builds motor skills, team spirit, and a whole lot of other goodness – in case the bosses are reading this.

Now this is no regular calculation, and of course it will be anything but accurate, but we decided that we'd rather err on the side of caution, and be extremely conservative with our suppositions – the final figure will no doubt be a lot higher than what we arrive at.

Indian farmers?

To get anywhere, we'll first have to find out (very) roughly how many people in India play FarmVille. For this, we'll go both with Zynga's global stats and the stats given out by Zynga India head,

Shan Kadavil^[1]. We have numbers available for monthly Zynga logins globally (250 million), monthly

FarmVille logins globally (60 million) and daily Zynga logins from India (1.5 million). Since FarmVille accounts for 24 per cent of the monthly Zynga logins globally, let's apply the same percentage for the daily Zynga logins from India.

FarmVille probably accounts for a higher percentage of traffic in India given its popularity here. We'll ignore that for now though, and like we said earlier, try and work out a rough figure to work with. 24 per cent of 15,00,000 works out to around **3,60,000 Indians playing FarmVille every day.**

Workaholics anonymous

We went through various studies, and found that about 40 per cent of all Indians online using a PC, log in from their workplace during work hours^[2].

Applying the nationwide average to our FarmVille users – despite logic and several studies suggesting that the numbers are probably much higher – we arrive at the

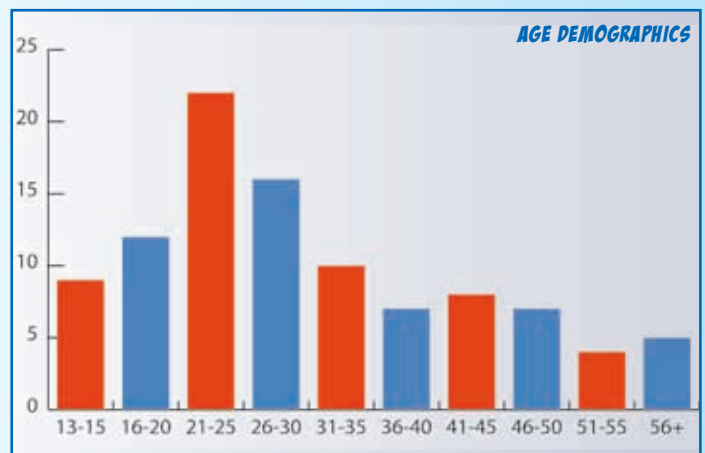
following figure:

$3,60,000 \times 40\% = 1,44,000$ users playing FarmVille at work daily!

Give us our daily wages!

According to Zynga's Director of Brand Advertising, Manny Anekal, the average time spent by an Indian playing FarmVille is 68 minutes a day^[3]. Assuming that most of us office going Indians work 8 hours a day (we certainly don't have that luxury, especially during issue closing), that's $(68 / 480) \times 100 = 14.17$ per cent of their work day on FarmVille.

Now, the per capita income in India is ₹46,492, and according to another study, the average income of an Indian who has access to the internet is 3.2 times the national average. This means 3.2



Here is the age spread of people logging into FarmVille. Age 21-25 wins

